

Planning
Culminating Writing Project
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¶ 1-3	Selected Character:		Choose the character from <i>Of Mice and Men</i> you will analyze. For these instructions, we'll use the character George as an example. Remember that you may use the same quotes from the examples provided in class to support your points. However, your analysis must be in your own words.
¶ 1	Character's Dream:		Briefly describe the main goal or dream of your chosen character. For example, if you're working with George, his dream is to own a piece of land and live independently with Lennie.
	Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. a. 2. a.	List two ways that having this dream benefits the character. For George, a benefit is that it gives him hope and direction. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream benefits the character.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	List characters who positively influence the character's pursuit of the dream. For George, you might mention Lennie, who reminds him of the dream and keeps him focused.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship	• •	List characters who negatively influence the character's pursuit of the dream.

	with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:		
¶ 2	Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	List two negative effects of the dream. For example, George's plans are repeatedly derailed when Lennie gets into serious trouble. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream hurts/harms the character.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:	• •	List characters who help reduce these negative effects.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:	• •	List characters who worsen the negative aspects. Lennie's behavior, for example, sometimes makes George's dream feel impossible.
¶ 3	Barriers List (Challenges Arising	1. - a.	Identify two major obstacles or challenges the character faces as the character pursues his or her dream. For George, a

	that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):	2. a.	significant barrier is that killing Lennie drains him of all motivation. Locate and record quotes that demonstrate how each barrier impedes or halts the character's progress in pursuing his or her dream.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:	• •	List characters who help the character overcome these barriers.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:	• •	List characters who make it harder to overcome the barriers. In this case, George's relationship to George contributes to George failing to overcome the barrier. Because it is a joint dream, without Lennie, it is no longer an achievable dream.

¶¶ 4-6	Selected Character:		Choose the character from <i>Of Mice and Men</i> you will analyze. For body paragraphs 4-6, I suggest choosing Lennie.
¶ 4	Character's Dream:		Briefly describe the main goal or dream of your chosen character.
	Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. a. 2. a.	List two ways that having this dream benefits the character. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream benefits the character.

	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	List characters who positively influence the character's pursuit of the dream.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	List characters who negatively influence the character's pursuit of the dream.
¶ 5	Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	List two negative effects of the dream. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream hurts/harms the character.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:	• •	List characters who help reduce these negative effects.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship	• •	List characters who worsen the negative aspects.

	with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:		
¶ 6	Barriers List (Challenges Arising that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):	1. - a. 2. - a.	Identify two major obstacles or challenges the character faces as the character pursues his or her dream. Locate and record quotes that demonstrate how each barrier impedes or halts the character's progress in pursuing his or her dream.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:	• •	List characters who help the character overcome these barriers.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:	• •	List characters who make it harder to overcome the barriers.

¶¶ 7-9	Selected Character:		Choose the character from <i>Of Mice and Men</i> you will analyze. For body paragraphs 4-6, I suggest choosing either Candy or Curley's wife.
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¶ 7	Character's Dream:		Briefly describe the main goal or dream of your chosen character.
	Dream Benefits List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Benefits the Character in the Novel):	1. - a. 2. - a.	List two ways that having this dream benefits the character. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream benefits the character.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Helped Him/Her Move Toward or Attain the Dream:	• •	List characters who positively influence the character's pursuit of the dream.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Hindered His/Her Movement Toward or Attainment of the Dream:	• •	List characters who negatively influence the character's pursuit of the dream.
¶ 8	Dream Detriments List (How Having—not Necessarily <i>Achieving</i> —the Dream Hurt/Harmed the Character in the	1. - a. 2. - a.	List two negative effects of the dream. Locate and record quotes that show each way that having this dream hurts/harms the character.

	Novel):		
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Positive) Mitigated or Rectified the Hurt/Harm:	• •	List characters who help reduce these negative effects.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character (Negative) Caused, Worsened, or Increased the Severity of the Hurt/Harm:	• •	List characters who worsen the negative aspects.
¶ 9	Barriers List (Challenges Arising that Impede or Halt Character as He/She Pursues His/Her Dream):	1. - a. 2. - a.	Identify two major obstacles or challenges the character faces as the character pursues his or her dream. Locate and record quotes that demonstrate how each barrier impedes or halts the character's progress in pursuing his or her dream.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship with Character Help in Successfully Overcoming Barriers:	• •	List characters who help the character overcome these barriers.
	Other Characters Whose Relationship	• •	List characters who make it harder to overcome the barriers.

	with Character Contribute to Failing to Overcome Barriers:		
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Glossary

Analyze: Look at something closely to understand it better; break down into parts to understand.
Barrier: An obstacle or something that gets in the way; something that makes it hard to achieve a goal.
Benefit: A good thing; something that helps or is useful.
Burden: A heavy responsibility or a difficult duty; something that weighs you down.
Commitment: A promise or strong dedication to something; something you are determined to do.
Conflict: A problem or struggle; when two people or things don't agree.
Creates Conflict: Causes a problem or disagreement.
Detriment: A harm or negative effect; something that hurts or makes things worse.
Dream (in this context): A goal or hope for the future; something you really want.
Economic Challenges: Money problems; struggles related to earning, saving, or spending money.
Example: A model or sample; something used to show or explain an idea.
Explanation: An answer that makes something clearer; saying why or how something happens.
Goal: A purpose or something you want to achieve.
Guide: To lead or help; something that shows the way.
Impact: The effect or result of something; how something changes things.
Influence: The power to change or affect something or someone.
Interpretation: Your understanding or way of explaining something.
Mitigate: To make something less bad; reduce the harm.
Motivate: To make someone want to do something; encourage.
Obstacle: Something that gets in the way; a problem or challenge.
Organize: Arrange or put in order; make clear and neat.
Permanently: Forever; something that doesn't change back.
Pursue: To try to get or achieve; to follow a goal.
Purpose: Reason for doing something; goal.
Realistic: Something true to life; believable or sensible.

Reflect: To show something or think about it deeply; to represent.
Reinforce: To make stronger; support.
Relationship: A connection or bond between people.
Remind: To make someone remember something.
Responsibility: A duty or job; something you're supposed to do.
Result: The outcome or effect; what happens because of something.
Risk: The chance of something bad happening; danger.
Setback: A delay or something that slows progress; a problem.
Situation: The way things are; the setting or condition.
Stable: Steady and secure; safe and unchanging.
Structure: The way something is organized or put together.
Support: To help or back up.
Threatens: To say or act like you will harm someone; to make someone feel unsafe.
Topic: The main subject or idea.
Unique: Different from all others; special or one of a kind.